

FileFlow – User Guide

A lightweight local file manager that runs directly in your browser.
No installation, no cloud, no data leaves your machine.

Requirements

- **Browser:** Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge only
 - **File:** Save `fileflow.html` locally and open it directly in Chrome/Edge
 - Firefox is **not supported** (it blocks local file system access)
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Getting Started

1. Save `fileflow.html` to your PC (e.g. Desktop or Documents)
2. Double-click the file to open it in Chrome or Edge
3. Click **Open Folder** in the top toolbar
4. Choose any folder on your PC when the picker appears
5. Click **Allow** when the browser asks for permission (once per session)

You'll need to re-grant permission each time you open the app — this is a browser security requirement, not a bug.

Toolbar Buttons

Button	What it does
Open Folder	Pick any folder on your PC to browse
+ Folder	Create a new subfolder inside the current folder
 Delete (n)	Delete selected items — shows count when items are selected
↑ Up	Go up one level to the parent folder
↺ Refresh	Reload the current folder (useful after external changes)
Search box	Filter files/folders by name in the current view

Navigating Folders

- **Double-click** a folder to open it
 - Use the **breadcrumb bar** (top, below the toolbar) to jump back to any parent folder
 - Click any folder name in the breadcrumb to go directly there
 - Use **↑ Up** or press `Backspace` equivalent via the button to go up one level
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Selecting Files & Folders

Action	How
Select one item	Click it
Deselect	Click it again
Select multiple	<code>Ctrl + Click</code> each item
Select all visible	<code>Ctrl + A</code>
Select via checkbox	Tick the checkbox on the left of each row
Select/deselect all	Tick the checkbox in the header row
Clear selection	Press <code>Escape</code>

Managing Files

Rename a file

- Right-click → **Rename**, or select the file and press `F2`
- Type the new name and press `Enter` to confirm, `Escape` to cancel
- ⚠ **Folders cannot be renamed** via FileFlow (browser limitation) — use Windows Explorer for that

Delete files or folders

- Select one or more items, then click  **Delete** or press `Del`
- A confirmation prompt will appear before anything is removed
- Deletion is **permanent** — items do not go to the Recycle Bin

Create a new folder

- Click + **Folder** and type a name when prompted
 - The new folder appears immediately in the current view
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Sorting

Click any column header to sort by that column:

Column	Sorts by
Name	Alphabetical (A-Z)
Size	File size (smallest first)
Modified	Date last changed (oldest first)

Click the same column again to **reverse** the sort order. An arrow (↑ or ↓) shows the active sort. Folders always appear **above** files regardless of sort.

Searching

- Type in the **Search** box to filter items in the current folder
 - Matches any part of the file or folder name
 - Search does **not** look inside subfolders — navigate into them to search there
 - Clear the search box to return to the full view
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Right-Click Menu

Right-click any file or folder for quick actions:

- **Open folder** (folders only) — same as double-clicking
 - **Rename** — inline rename in the row
 - **Delete** — deletes the item (or all selected items if multiple are selected)
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Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Action
F2	Rename selected item
Delete	Delete selected item(s)
Ctrl + A	Select all visible items
Escape	Clear selection / cancel rename
Enter	Confirm rename

Status Bar

The bar at the bottom shows:

- Total folder and file count in the current view
- Total size of all files in the folder
- Number of currently selected items (in purple)
- Number of search results when filtering

Known Limitations

Limitation	Reason
Folders cannot be renamed	Browser File System API restriction — use Windows Explorer
Files are not moved to Recycle Bin on delete	API limitation — deletion is permanent
Permission must be re-granted each session	Browser security requirement
Does not work in Firefox	Firefox does not support the File System Access API
No drag-and-drop move between folders	Not currently supported
Cannot preview file contents	Not in scope for this version

Tips

- Pin `fileflow.html` to your taskbar or Start menu for quick access
 - Keep it in a fixed location (e.g. `C:\Tools\fileflow.html`) so your browser remembers it
 - Use ↻ **Refresh** if you've made changes to the folder outside of FileFlow
 - For bulk deletes, use `Ctrl + A` to select everything, then deselect what you want to keep before deleting
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FileFlow runs entirely in your browser. No data is sent anywhere.